

by committing to achieve net-zero emissions by 2070.

But one area where there is a gap is the lack of specific regulations pertaining to greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions from sporting events.

“There are no regulations in India requiring monitoring, reporting, or control measures with respect to GHG emissions for sporting events, except when a particular GHG may be covered under another regulation due to its toxicity, health hazard, or other impacts,” says Bose Varghese, Senior Director-ESG at Cyril Amarchand Mangaldas. Besides, he adds, CSR rules are only applicable to companies. Federations are not covered.

Of course, the event organiser can announce initiatives proactively. In fact, there are several international initiatives that Indian organisers could adopt, says Sareen of Dalberg Advisors. “These include ISO 20121: Event Sustainability Management System, an international standard that provides a framework for managing the social, economic, and environmental impacts of an event, including measures to address climate change,” he says.

There’s also the UNFCCC Sports for Climate Action Framework that calls on organisations to prepare a strategy to achieve climate neutrality for their events. Then there’s the Green Sports Alliance, which offers resources and guidance on sustainability in sports; the Carbon Trust Standard for Sport certification programme that helps sports organisations and venues worldwide measure, manage and reduce carbon emissions; and the Global Reporting Initiative, which provides sustainability reporting standards.

LOADS TO DO

While the initiatives undertaken by the ICC and its official partners like Booking.com and even stadiums are

CLEAN UP

Initiatives undertaken by the ICC to reduce carbon emissions for ICC Men’s Cricket World Cup India 2023

► Plastic recycling machines being installed at every venue; waste to be turned into ICC staff clothing for future events

► Waste management project in partnership with Coca-Cola and United Way Mumbai for waste segregation and reducing landfill

► Consult with venues and spectators on ways to reduce waste in the future

► Flags on the field of play for anthem ceremonies are made from recycled plastic

► ICC is also planning to undertake a carbon footprint audit of the current World Cup in consultation with member countries

► It plans to develop a global sustainability strategy for the sport that will be implemented in 2024



a good start, these may not suffice.

A three-pillar approach can be taken to decarbonise the tournament—strategise, digitise, and decarbonise, explains says Deepak Sharma, Zone President, Greater India, and MD & CEO Schneider Electric India. It should start with developing a strategy to measure the emission footprint and create a decarbonisation road map. As a next step, it’s important to digitise resource use and monitor emissions. For instance, Schneider Electric’s digital solutions have been used across multiple stadiums globally, such as the Melbourne Cricket Ground (MCG) in Australia, to help reduce its emissions footprint.

“In the MCG, with our complete range of solutions, we have helped [it] discover up to 50 per cent energy-saving opportunities along with safer and improved asset management,” says Sharma.

Finally, a decarbonisation action plan must be implemented that should include reducing the use of resources such as electricity, fuel, water, etc. Avoiding on-site diesel generators should be considered. While not much can be done about the emissions generated by air travel during the tournament, for locals, free access to public transportation for all ticketholders and accredited staff (including metro) should be offered. This could be bundled with e-vehicles for the movement of staff and players, as was done at the first edition of MotoGP Bharat held in September in Uttar Pradesh. And for drinks served at stadiums or even otherwise, bottles made from recycled plastic could be considered.

Climate change cannot be addressed with a single initiative. But every single initiative counts. **BT**

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